

2.3.6 Character and suitability

A traffic controller must be of good character and be a suitable person to entrust to exercise their authority in a professional, responsible and safety conscious manner. Traffic controllers interact with emergency services, motorists and other road workers in dynamic and high-risk road environments. A traffic controller must be of suitable temperament and disposition to act appropriately and assertively in all circumstances.

If during the period of accreditation, the traffic controller is convicted of a potentially disqualifying offence, the traffic controller may be required to give written notice of the matter to the relevant authority representative within 14 days of the conviction occurring.

When applying the pre-requisite check, the following can be taken into account:

- nature of the offence/s
- the relevance of the offence/s to the role requirements
- when the offence/s occurred
- nature of the penalty applied.

The intention of the pre-requisite check is not to re-penalise the person, but instead to look objectively at the offence/s and the associated risk implications to the public of performing the required duties of a traffic controller.

At the time of publication of this Guide, the following are considered to be disqualifying offences that would generally make an applicant unsuitable for accreditation as a traffic controller:

- offences of a violent nature such as serious assault, rape, attempted homicide, homicide, manslaughter, burglary, and major drug offences
 - where convictions were recorded in a Magistrate's Court in the past five years, or
 - where convictions were recorded in a District Court or higher court in the past 10 years.
- offences such as fraud, assault, drug possession, theft, break and enter
 - where convictions were recorded in a Magistrate's Court or higher court within the past three years.

Any offences under the relevant jurisdictional legislation and regulation, can be considered by the relevant authority in making a decision regarding the person's suitability.

2.3.7 Site climatic conditions

Ensure preparation for duty considers extreme climatic conditions, whether cold or hot. Where heat or high humidity are likely to be factors at the site, it is recommended the traffic controller takes care of themselves to ensure adequate hydration, and that cooling packs or other thermoregulation devices may be prepared in advance of the shift. It is recommended the traffic controller have adequate fluids and refreshments on hand at the site. It is suggested that the garments worn during hot days are to allow maximum air flow, be of light weight and be able to accommodate a cooling pack harness if needed. Wear garments that adhere to the requirements outlined in Section 2.5.

It is recommended that traffic controllers have appropriate garments on hand at the site to accommodate changing environmental conditions (such as rain) during the course of the shift. Any clothing worn for wet weather cannot obscure the high visibility garments required to ensure the visibility of the traffic controller to road users.